ScopeGuard — AI Usage and Decision Log

1. How I Used AI

I used AI as a development and thinking assistant while building ScopeGuard. My use of AI focused on:

- **Product planning:** Defining the core problem, target users, MVP features and user workflow.
- **Prototype development:** Getting assistance with the React/Vite implementation, interface structure, request classification logic and debugging.
- **Testing and refinement:** Reviewing expected behaviour across included requests, out-of-scope requests and ambiguous requests.
- **Business planning:** Drafting the competitive comparison, pricing hypothesis, customer acquisition approach, validation plan and risks.
- **Marketing assets:** Developing the messaging for the Instagram creative and freelancer outreach message.

I reviewed the outputs and made decisions based on the assignment requirements and the product's intended use. AI-generated suggestions were treated as inputs to evaluate, not automatically accepted as correct.

2. Example of AI-Assisted Development

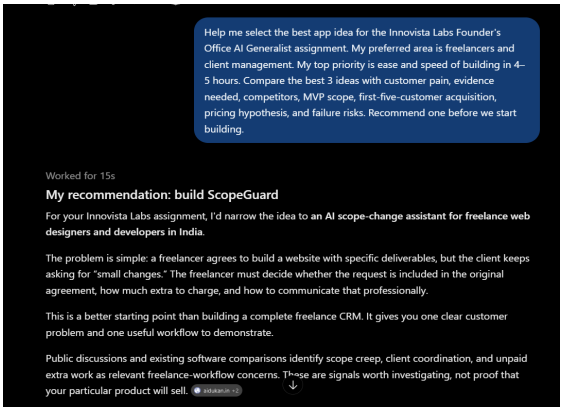
Task: Build a tool that helps freelance web designers and developers assess incoming client requests against the original project scope.

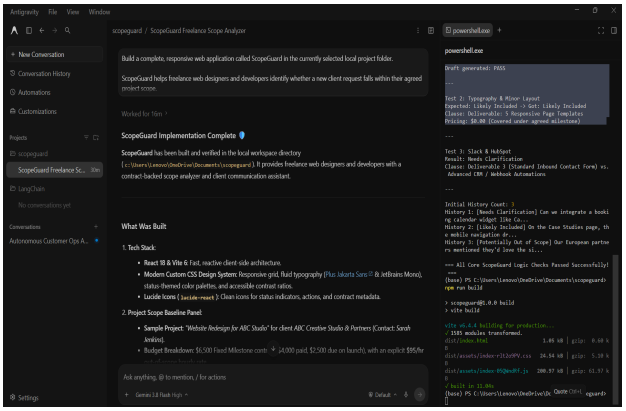
Approach: I developed a prototype with three outcomes:

- Likely Included
- Potentially Out of Scope
- Needs Clarification

The interface shows the reasoning behind a classification and supports drafting a professional client response. I also tested representative scenarios, including e-commerce checkout, typography changes and CRM integrations.

Verification: The automated logic checks passed, and the production build completed successfully. These results establish that the tested prototype workflow works; they do not establish real-world classification accuracy or customer demand.





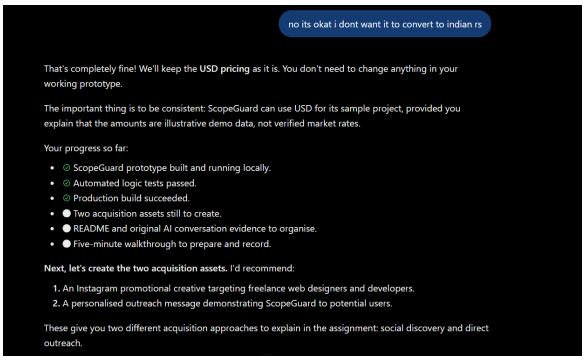
3. A Decision I Challenged

Decision area: Currency and pricing presentation.

During the development process, I clarified that the illustrative contract values in the prototype should remain in USD rather than being converted to INR. The sample contract uses a $6,500 budget and a $95/hour out-of-scope rate.

I kept this separate from the business recommendation's proposed ₹499/month subscription price. The former represents illustrative contract data inside the product; the latter is an unvalidated pricing hypothesis for ScopeGuard itself.

Why this matters: Mixing these two contexts could make the prototype inconsistent and confuse users about what the amounts represent. I prioritised keeping the product's sample data consistent while presenting the proposed subscription price separately.



4. Limitations I Recognised

- The prototype uses a local, simulated heuristic rather than a live AI model or external API.
- Keyword-based classifications may miss context, misunderstand a request or flag a request incorrectly.
- Cost estimates depend on illustrative assumptions and should not be treated as reliable quotations.
- The prototype has not been validated with real customers.

- The pricing, acquisition and validation targets in the recommendation are hypotheses or proposed plans, not achieved results.

A future version could explore AI-assisted interpretation of contract clauses, but only after testing accuracy, privacy requirements and the value of the workflow with target users.

5. My Takeaway

AI helped me move faster from a problem statement to a working prototype and supporting business materials. My role was to define the problem, select the scope, check the implementation, question assumptions and distinguish verified results from hypotheses.

The key lesson is that generating an output is only one part of the work. The output must still be tested, reviewed and judged against the user's actual needs.